



Mark Scheme (Results)

November 2025

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE in Business
4BS1/02

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

Q. No.	Which one of the following is a financial aim of a business? Answer	Mark
1(a) (i)	AO1 – 1 mark The only correct answer is A – Survival B – is not the correct answer as independence is a non-financial aim of a business C – is not the correct answer as control is a non-financial aim of a business D – is not the correct answer as challenge is a non-financial aim of a business	(1)

Q. No.	Which one of the following is a job in the secondary sector? Answer	Mark
1(a) (ii)	AO1 – 1 mark The only correct answer is D – Ship builder A – is not the correct answer as a farmer works in the primary sector B – is not the correct answer as a grocery store manager works in the tertiary sector C – is not the correct answer as a restaurant waiter works in the tertiary sector	(1)

Q. No.	Which one of the following is the total daily remuneration cost for the three factories? Answer	Mark
1(a) (iii)	AO2 – 1 mark The only correct answer is D – €57 000 A – is not the correct answer as €15 000 is 125 x €120 B – is not the correct answer as €16 800 is 140 x €120 C – is not the correct answer as €25 200 is 210 x €120	(1)

Q. No.	Which one of the following is an advantage of a hierarchical organisational structure? Answer	Mark
1 (a) (iv)	AO1 – 1 mark The only correct answer is C – It has more job promotion opportunities for its employees A – is not the correct answer as it is more expensive than a flat organisation structure B – is not the correct answer because a flat structure has a short chain of command D – is not the correct answer because a flat structure has a wide span of control	(1)

Q. No.	Which one of the following is the net cash flow for this month? Answer	Mark
1 (a) (v)	AO2 – 1 mark The only correct answer is B – €25 000 A – is not the correct answer as €17 000 is the opening balance minus the cash inflow C – is not the correct answer as €42 000 is the opening balance minus cash outflow D – is not the correct answer as €101 000 is the opening balance plus cash inflow minus cash outflow	(1)

Q. No.	Which one of the following best describes Taylor's motivational theory? Answer	Mark
1 (a) (vi)	AO1 – 1 mark The only correct answer is A – workers are motivated by money B – is not the correct answer as esteem needs relate to Maslow's theory of motivation C – is not the correct answer as hygiene factors relate to Herzberg's theory of motivation D – is not the correct answer as working in a team relates to Maslow's theory of motivation	(1)

Q. No.	Define the term job rotation .	Mark
	Answer	
1(b)	AO1 – 1 mark Award 1 mark for a correct definition of job rotation . • Employees spending a period of time in different jobs/departments (1)	(1)

Q. No.	Define the term interest rate .	Mark
	Answer	
1(c)	AO1 – 1 mark Award 1 mark for a correct definition of interest rate . • A percentage charged for borrowing money/reward for saving money (1)	(1)

Q. No.	State one job that an employee of <i>Samsung</i> might do in the production department.	Mark
	Answer	
1(d)	AO2 – 1 mark Award 1 mark for a job that an employee of <i>Samsung</i> may do in the production department • A <i>Samsung</i> employee may work on the production line that makes laptops (1) • A <i>Samsung</i> employee may be responsible for the quality control of the TV's (1) NB Do not accept a reason that is not in the context of <i>Samsung</i> Accept any appropriate response	(1)

Q. No.	Calculate the factory's productivity of smartphones per hour. You are advised to show your working Answer	Additional Guidance	Mark
1(e)	A02 – 2 marks Award 2 marks for the correct answer 50 (2) OR award 1 mark for workings if final answer is incorrect 1000 / 20 (1)	Award 1 mark for correctly substituting numbers into formula. Award full marks for correct answer with no working.	(2)

Q. No.	Explain one advantage to a business of mass marketing. Answer	Mark
1(f)	A01 – 3 marks Award 1 mark for identification of an advantage to a business of mass marketing, plus 2 further marks for explaining the advantage, for a maximum of 3 marks. • More sales may be generated (1) as the product is promoted to a large number of people (1) which may improve the profitability of the business (1) NB No marks are awarded for a definition. Answers that list three reasons with no explanation will get 1 mark only. Accept any appropriate response.	(3)

Q. No.	Analyse how recruitment documents may help <i>Samsung</i> to hire the best employees for its business Indicative content	Mark
1(g)	AO2 = 3 marks AO3 = 3 marks AO2 • <i>Samsung</i> can review the information contained in the curriculum vitae (CV) of the applicants to consider the previous experience of the design engineers • <i>Samsung</i> can use a person specification to stipulate the education and skills required by the recruits to manufacture and design TV's and smartphones AO3 • The CV can be used by <i>Samsung</i> to decide if the applicant experience match the requirements of jobs in its business. • This should lead to <i>Samsung</i> only receiving applications from people who have the skills required to help them compete in the electronics market	(6)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1-2	- Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context (AO2) - Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points (AO3)
Level 2	3-4	- Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies (AO3)
Level 3	5-6	- Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning (AO3)

Q. No.	State one reason why <i>Samsung</i> may need long-term finance.	Mark
	Answer	
2 (a)	AO2 – 1 mark Award 1 mark for a reason why <i>Samsung</i> may need long term finance. • To fund the research and development of new smartphones (1) • To build a new factory to manufacture laptops (1) NB Do not accept a reason that is not in the context of <i>Samsung</i>. Accept any appropriate response.	(1)

Q. No.	State one reason why quality control is a benefit to <i>Samsung</i>	Mark
	Answer	
2 (b)	AO2 – 1 mark Award 1 mark for a valid reason why quality control is a benefit to <i>Samsung</i> • Poor quality laptops are likely to be detected before they are shipped to customers (1) NB Do not accept a reason that is not in the context of <i>Samsung</i>. Accept any appropriate response.	(1)

Q. No.	Explain one advantage to a business of having a social objective. Answer	Mark
2 (c)	A01 – 3 marks Award 1 mark for identification of an advantage to a business of having a social objective , plus 2 further marks for explaining the advantage, for a maximum of 3 marks. • The business can gain a good reputation (1) from creating a positive impact on society (1) resulting in more potential customers (1) • The business may attract employees (1) who are interesting in environmental problems (1) leading to a wider pool of talent/skills in the business (1) NB No marks are awarded for a definition. Answers that list three reasons with no explanation will get a 1 mark only. Accept any appropriate response.	(3)

Q. No.	Explain one limitation of a break-even chart. Answer	Mark
2 (d)	A01 – 3 marks Award 1 mark for identification of one limitation of a break-even chart plus 2 further marks for explaining the limitations, for a maximum of 3 marks. • Break-even is based on predictions (1) which may result in incorrect forecast (1) leading to wasted resources (1) NB No marks are awarded for a definition. Answers that list three reasons with no explanation will get a 1 mark only. Accept any appropriate response.	(3)

Q. No.	Explain one benefit to a business of being located within a trading bloc. Answer	Mark
2 (e)	A01 – 3 marks Award 1 mark for identification of one benefit to a business of being located within a trading bloc, plus 2 further marks for explaining the benefit, for a maximum of 3 marks. • There is the potential for a business to increase sales (1) because a trading bloc encourages trade between member countries (1) therefore a business has a wider pool of customers (1) • Costs of imported materials may decrease for the business (1) as tariffs are likely to be reduced or eliminated in the trading bloc (1) allowing the business to potentially increase its profits (1) NB No marks are awarded for a definition. Answers that list three effects with no explanation will get 1 mark only. Accept any appropriate response.	(3)

Q. No.	Option 1: Sponsor celebrities to use its products Option 2: Provide a free game app to customers when they purchase a product Justify which one of these two options <i>Samsung</i> should choose. Indicative content	Mark
2 (f)	AO2 = 3 marks, AO3 = 3 marks, AO4 = 3 marks AO2 • Option 1 – <i>Samsung</i> could pay fees to a celebrity for using its smartphones as a way of getting publicity for its products • Option 2 – free game applications may encourage young people to buy a <i>Samsung</i> smartphone rather than one from <i>Apple</i> AO3 • Option 1 – People are influenced by celebrities and if they see their idols using the smartphone they may be encouraged to buy the same one • Option 2 – Some consumers may perceive the free apps as an attractive special offer which may persuade them to choose the <i>Samsung</i> smartphone rather than any other alternative AO4 • Option 1 – However, if the person chosen by <i>Samsung</i> to advertise its products is involved in a scandal this may ruin the reputation of <i>Samsung</i> and lead to a decrease in demand • Option 2 – However, some people will be more concerned with other features/apps on a smartphone and may not be attracted to the special offer of free games	(9)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No Rewardable material.
Level 1	1-3	• Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context. (AO2) • Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a simple justification based on limited evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 2	4-6	• Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies. (AO2) • Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a justification based on sound evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 3	7 - 9	• Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout. (AO2) • Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a clear justification based on a thorough evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)

Q. No.	Define the term exporter .	Mark
	Answer	
3 (a)	A01 – 1 mark Award 1 mark for a correct definition of exporter. A business/individual that sells products/services to another country	(1)

Q. No.	Outline one advantage to <i>Samsung</i> of using flow production when manufacturing its products.	Mark
	Answer	
3 (b)	A02 – 2 marks Award 2 marks for linked points outlining an advantage to <i>Samsung</i> of using flow production when manufacturing its products. Award a maximum of 1 mark if points are not linked. <i>Samsung</i> can produce a large number of smartphones on its production lines (1) allowing <i>Samsung</i> to lower its unit costs (1) NB To award 2 marks there must be linked points and evidence of application. Accept any other appropriate response.	(2)

Q. No.	Calculate the selling price of the laptop. You are advised to show your workings. Answer	Additional Guidance	Mark
3 (c)	A02 – 2 marks Award 2 marks for the correct answer 650 000 KRW (2) OR award 1 mark for workings if final answer is incorrect $520\,000 \times 25\% = 130\,000$ KRW (1)	Award full marks for correct answer with no working. Award 1 mark for correctly substituting numbers into formula.	(2)

Q. No.	Analyse why profit is important to <i>Samsung</i> . Indicative content	Mark
3 (d)	A02 = 3 marks A03 = 3 marks A02 <i>Samsung</i> invests large amount of funding to design and develop innovative electronic products such as smartphones <i>Samsung</i> is a public limited company and is currently the leading manufacturer of TV's A03 - High levels of profit will allow <i>Samsung</i> to reinvest its profits into new technology to compete in the market - High levels of profit may attract further funds from investors who may be enticed by the possibility of high returns on their investments	(6)

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	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1-2	- Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context (AO2) - Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points (AO3)
Level 2	3-4	- Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies (AO3)
Level 3	5-6	- Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning (AO3)

Q. No.	Option 1: Just in time (JIT) Option 2: Kaizen (e) Justify which one of these two options <i>Samsung</i> should choose to minimise costs. Indicative content	Mark
3 (e)	AO2 = 3 marks, AO3 = 3 marks, AO4 = 3 marks AO2 • Option 1 – JIT will allow <i>Samsung</i> to receive delivery of electronic parts for its manufacture of laptops as required on the assembly line • Option 2 – Kaizen will encourage a culture of continuous improvement to may help <i>Samsung</i> reduce waste when manufacturing its laptops and TV's AO3 • Option 1 – JIT will reduce the storage costs of its electronic parts if supplies are delivered only when required rather than having to store them in a warehouse • Option 2 – Reduced waste in the factory will help keep costs of laptops low which will help them compete with businesses such as <i>Apple</i> AO4 • Option 1 – However, if suppliers deliver in smaller batches this may increase the delivery cost of materials which will increase the total cost of production • Option 2 – However, introducing Kaizen will take time and require training of employees which may increase costs for <i>Samsung</i> in the short term	(9)

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	0	No Rewardable material.
Level 1	1-3	- Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context. (AO2) - Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points. (AO3) - Makes a judgement, providing a simple justification based on limited evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 2	4-6	- Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies. (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies. (AO3) - Makes a judgement, providing a justification based on sound evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 3	7 - 9	- Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout. (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning. (AO3) - Makes a judgement, providing a clear justification based on a thorough evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)

Q. No.	Calculate, to two decimal places, the operating profit margin You are advised to show your workings. Answer	Additional Guidance	Mark
4 (a)	A02 – 2 marks Award 2 marks for the correct answer 8.26 % (2) OR award 1 mark for workings if final answer is incorrect 112 000 – 94 000 = 18 000 (1)	Award full marks for correct answer with no working. Award 1 mark for correctly substituting numbers into formula.	(2)

Q. No.	Analyse the purpose of market research for <i>Samsung</i> . Indicative content	Mark
4 (b)	A02 = 3 marks A03 = 3 marks A02 <i>Samsung</i> are able to identify and understand its customer's needs in terms of what they look for when buying a laptop or TV - Market research will help <i>Samsung</i> identify potential gaps in the competitive smartphone market A03 <i>Samsung</i> can consider the features customers prefer to increase demand for its products - This, this may lead to <i>Samsung</i> developing a USP to attract more customers	(6)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1-2	- Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context (AO2) - Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points (AO3)
Level 2	3-4	- Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies (AO3)
Level 3	5-6	- Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout (AO2) - Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning (AO3)

Q. No.	Evaluate whether a centralised organisation structure will benefit <i>Samsung</i>. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business. Indicative content	Mark
4 (c)	AO1 = 3 marks AO2 = 3 marks AO3 = 3 marks AO4 = 3 marks <u>AO1</u> • A centralised organisation structure is where business decisions are made at the headquarters of the business • It is usual in a centralised structure that decisions for the whole business are made by the CEO and other senior managers <u>AO2</u> • This means that major decisions on the design and the development of smartphones will be made in South Korea to speed up the decision making • It means that <i>Samsung</i> can benefit from economies of scale if TVs are standardised and the marketing can be organised centrally <u>AO3</u> • This will ensure <i>Samsung</i> can react quickly to changes in technology which is of importance in the competitive smartphone market to ensure it maintains its market share • A reduction in unit costs may help reduce prices of the TVs to help them remain the leading supplier in the industry <u>AO4</u> • However, lack of authority lower in the organisation may demotivate managers leading to lower productivity/ employees leaving their jobs resulting in higher costs and lower profit levels • However, local managers in the factories and offices outside South Korea may have a better understanding of local needs /be in a better position to attract more customers	(12)

Level	Mark	Descriptor
	0	No Rewardable material.
Level 1	1–4	• Demonstrates elements of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues, with limited business terminology used. (AO1) • Limited application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context. (AO2) • Attempts to deconstruct business information and/or issues, finding limited connections between points. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a simple justification based on limited evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 2	5 – 8	• Demonstrates mostly accurate knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues including appropriate use of business terminology in places. (AO1) • Sound application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context although there may be some inconsistencies. (AO2) • Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding interconnected points with chains of reasoning, although there may be some logical inconsistencies. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a justification based on sound evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)
Level 3	9 – 12	• Demonstrates accurate knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues throughout, including appropriate use of business terminology. (AO1) • Detailed application of knowledge and understanding of business concepts and issues to the business context throughout. (AO2) • Deconstructs business information and/or issues, finding detailed interconnected points with logical chains of reasoning. (AO3) • Makes a judgement, providing a clear justification based on a thorough evaluation of business information and issues relevant to the choice made. (AO4)